

CLAUDE.md — Before & After

What changes when your agent gets a memory layer it can actually navigate

Every file-aware coding agent reads **CLAUDE.md** first. Most people leave it empty or fill it with a sentence. Here is what happens when you give it real structure.

Before

BEFORE — Day 0
<pre># Project This is my project. I'm building a SaaS app. Tech: React, Node, Postgres. ## Notes - Remember to use TypeScript. - The auth is Firebase for now. - Ask me if you're not sure about something.</pre>

The agent knows the stack. That's it. Every session, you re-explain the project, the rules, the architecture, the people, the decisions.

After

AFTER — 10 Minutes Later

```
# CLAUDE.md – Agent Context Loader

## Who
- Name: Jordan Park
- Role: Solo founder, Tempo (task management SaaS)

## Active Projects
- Tempo v2: Migration from Firebase to Supabase Auth.
  See [[Auth Migration – Firebase to Supabase]]
- Tempo Billing: Stripe integration. See [[Billing Hub]]

## Stack
- TypeScript, React, Next.js, Supabase, Postgres, Vercel

## Preferences
- Be direct. No boilerplate. Ask before creating files.
- Use [[wikilinks]] for all internal references.

## Standing Rules
- Check wiki/ before searching raw/.
- Every new wiki note links back to a hub or MOC.
- Never create an unlinked note.
- When unsure where something goes: raw/ first.

## Vault Map
vault/
■ ■ CLAUDE.md ← you are here
■ ■ Home.md ← entry point
■ ■ raw/ incoming captures
■ ■ wiki/ linked knowledge
■ ■ skills/ agent instructions
■ ■ archive/ done or retired
```

The agent knows the project, the people, the architecture, where to look, how to link, and when to stop. You never re-explain any of it again.

The difference between these two files is the difference between an agent that searches blind and an agent that navigates.

What Grows From Here

After six months of use, a working vault has hub notes for every active project, person notes for key collaborators, concept notes that anchor recurring ideas, decision logs, MOCs that tie domains together, and a CLAUDE.md that reads like a team onboarding doc. The starter template gets you to day one. The structure gets you to month six.